



Gotabgaa Australia

UNITY . HERITAGE . EXCELLENCE

A warm invitation to review and vote

Together we grow - through trust, unity, and shared opportunity

Date: July 2026 | Status: Proposal for Interim Leadership review and vote

To: All Members of the Interim Leadership Team

Empowerment Fare (E-Fare)

Interest-free support, shared by our community

When we pool our strength, we lift one another.

DEAR INTERIM LEADERS

Thank you for taking time to read this. We offer E-Fare for your open discussion, kind feedback, and a clear vote. Our hope is simple: a programme our community can trust - fair to those who receive help, protective of the shared fund, and true to Gotabgaa's non-profit spirit.

1. What Is E-Fare?

Empowerment Fare (E-Fare) is a warm, practical way for members of Gotabgaa Australia to support one another financially - without bank interest, and without leaving anyone behind.

Members contribute a modest fee into a shared pool. When the programme is ready, selected members may receive interest-free support to start a business, invest wisely, study, or take another approved step towards a stronger future. In time, they return what they borrowed so the next family of members can be lifted too.

It is the spirit of kimnatet ak kibagege - unity and coming together - expressed in a simple, careful system.

IN A NUTSHELL

Join with a modest fee. Receive support in small groups of 2-3 members every six months. Return what you borrowed. Then another 2-3 members take their turn. Every dollar stays with the community. Gotabgaa does not profit.

2. Why E-Fare Matters

Many of us arrived in Australia with talent, courage, and big dreams. Yet starting a business, buying tools, or building stability can be hard when formal lending feels expensive or out of reach.

E-Fare offers a friendlier path: community support rooted in dignity and trust. As a non-profit, Gotabgaa's aim is not personal gain. It is to strengthen our people - in line with Empowerment and Growth and Investment Welfare.

3. How E-Fare Works

Six clear steps. Easy to follow. Fair for everyone.

Step 1

Join. Register for E-Fare by paying a modest participation fee (amount to be agreed by leadership). This builds the shared fund and shows your commitment.

Step 2

Grow the fund. As more members join, the pool grows. We start granting support only when the fund is strong enough to do so safely.

Step 3

Apply with a plan. Only 2-3 members receive support in each six-month cycle. Every applicant submits a clear Statement of Investment, evidence of the business the money will go into, and the names of three guarantors.

Step 4

Fair review. The E-Fare committee reviews the plan, business papers, and guarantors on merit. Incomplete applications - missing evidence or fewer than three acceptable guarantors - will not be approved, and no money will be released.

Step 5

Use and repay. Those 2-3 members repay within the six-month module. There is no interest.

Step 6

Pass it on. When amounts are returned, the next 2-3 members can be supported. The circle continues gently and continuously.

4. Sharing Fairly - Only 2-3 Members at a Time

We will keep the number of people receiving support carefully limited. This protects the fund, builds confidence, and gives each borrower the care they deserve.

The continuous circle

- Six-month modules: Each round lasts six months.
- Small groups only: At the start of a module, strictly 2-3 members may receive funds.
- Return what you borrow: Those members are expected to repay in full by the end of the module.
- Next round opens: As money returns, the next 2-3 members may be supported.
- It keeps going: Module 1 (2-3 members) -> repayment -> Module 2 (next 2-3) -> and so on.
- Friendly waiting list: Members not chosen this round stay on a clear queue for a later turn.
- No overcrowding: We do not start a new full group while the previous group is still fully unpaid - unless the committee records a clear, written exception.

WHY START SMALL?

Beginning with 2-3 members helps us learn, protect community money, and show that trust works. If leaders later agree by vote, we may grow the numbers thoughtfully.

5. Tell Us Your Plan - Statement of Investment

We gladly support real plans. Before money is released, every applicant must explain clearly what they will invest in and provide evidence. The community trusts you; your plan helps us trust the purpose.

What you need to include

- Statement of Investment: A short written plan covering what the money is for, expected benefit, a simple budget, and timeline.
- Evidence: Documents that support your plan. No statement, or no evidence, means the application cannot proceed.
- If it is a business: Please provide business registration (or proof that registration is underway), ABN where relevant, and related papers such as a brief plan, quotes, or lease/supplier documents as asked.
- If it is something else: Education, tools, or similar goals need matching evidence - for example enrolment, quotes, invoices, or licences.
- Extra help if needed: The committee may kindly ask for more documents, or decline applications that are unclear.

This keeps E-Fare honest, protective of the fund, and focused on genuine empowerment. Business borrowers must also meet the mandatory conditions in section 6 before any funds are released.

6. Borrowing from E-Fare - Mandatory Conditions

Any member who intends to borrow money from E-Fare must satisfy every condition below before funds are released. These rules protect the shared fund, the borrower, and the members who stand behind them. An application that does not meet them is incomplete and cannot proceed.

TWO THINGS THAT ARE NOT OPTIONAL

A member who intends to borrow must provide three guarantors, and must provide evidence of the business the money will be injected into - for example business registration and related papers. Both are required. One without the other is not enough.

1. Three guarantors - required

- Number: Exactly three guarantors must be named and accepted. Two, or one, is not sufficient.
- Who they are: Each guarantor must be a Gotabgaa Australia member in good standing, known to the committee, and willing to be contacted if repayment is missed.
- Written guarantee: Each guarantor signs a short written guarantee before any money is paid out. It states the borrower's name, the amount, the purpose, and that the guarantor supports the application.
- Separate people: The three guarantors must be three different people. They must not be the borrower. The committee may refuse a guarantor who lives in the same household as the borrower, or who is already guaranteeing another active E-Fare loan, if that would weaken the fund.
- What we record: Full name, membership details, phone, email, and a signed guarantee form for each guarantor. Unsigned or incomplete forms mean the loan is not approved.
- If repayment fails: Guarantors may be asked to help the committee reach the borrower, encourage a repayment plan, and - where the written guarantee says so - assist recovery of the outstanding amount. This is done with respect, in writing, and on record.
- Committee decision: The E-Fare committee may decline a proposed guarantor and ask for a replacement. Funds are not released until three acceptable guarantors are in place.

2. Evidence of the business the money will go into - required

- Business registration: Current registration of the business - for example an ABN, a registered business name, an ASIC company or business extract, or the relevant state or territory registration. A trading name alone, with no registration, is not enough.
- If registration is still being completed: Proof that the application has been lodged (receipt or reference number), the expected registration date, and a note that funds will not be used as personal spending while registration is pending. The committee may hold the money until registration is confirmed.

2. Evidence of the business the money will go into - required (continued)

- What the money is for: A clear statement of how the borrowed amount will be injected into that business - for example stock, tools, equipment, licences, fit-out, a vehicle used for the trade, or agreed working capital. Personal bills and purposes not listed in the plan are not allowed.
- Supporting papers: A simple budget; quotes, invoices, or supplier details; and, where relevant, a lease, licence, council permit, or professional registration connected to the business.
- Who owns the business: State your role - owner, partner, or director. If other people own it with you, write their names.
- Use of funds: Money must be used for the approved business purpose. The committee may ask for receipts after the loan is paid.
- No evidence, no loan: If business registration or equivalent evidence is missing, the application stops. The committee will not approve a business loan on a verbal description alone.

Before any money is released - checklist

- The member is a Gotabgaa Australia member in good standing and has joined E-Fare.
- A written Statement of Investment is complete (purpose, benefit, budget, and timeline).
- Three guarantors have been accepted and have signed.
- Business evidence is attached, including registration (or proof that registration is underway, if the committee agrees to wait).
- The E-Fare committee has approved the application in writing, including the amount and the repayment schedule.
- The member has signed the loan agreement, including the interest-free terms and the six-month repayment expectation.

These conditions apply to every member who intends to borrow for a business. Education or other approved purposes still need matching evidence, and the committee may also require guarantors for those loans. Business borrowing always requires both the three guarantors and the business evidence described above.

7. Our Promise - Interest-Free Support

E-Fare does not charge interest. That is a deliberate choice. We want empowerment to feel light on the shoulders, not heavy with debt.

Grant amounts and detailed rules will be published openly for all members, and refined with care as the programme grows.

8. Paying Back with Care

Timely repayment keeps the door open for the next members. We ask every borrower to honour the trust they have been given - and we will meet genuine hardship with listening and kindness first.

Simple repayment terms

- Timeframe: Usually six months from when funds are received (unless another plan is agreed in writing).
- Instalments: Clear, scheduled repayments set out in each member's agreement.
- Interest: None.
- Late admin fee: If repayment is overdue, a small fee of 1% to 2% of the outstanding amount may apply - only to encourage fairness, cover light admin costs, and protect the fund. It is not for profit.
- Hardship: Please contact the committee early. We will seek a caring solution before any penalty.

If repayment is delayed too long

- Stage 1: Friendly reminders and the small admin fee if overdue.
- Stage 2: If delay continues, or repayment seems avoided after a fair chance to arrange a plan, we escalate.
- Stage 3: A designated recovery body (or recovery officer) helps recover funds fairly, respectfully, and on record.
- Stage 4: In serious cases, E-Fare membership may be suspended for a set period, or ended - while recovery of the money continues. This is a last resort to protect everyone who plays fairly.

Firm where we must be. Friendly where we can be. Always fair.

9. Open and Accountable

Because Gotabgaa is a non-profit serving members - not investors - E-Fare will run in the open:

- A dedicated E-Fare committee with clear duties
- Published rules on joining, grant limits, fees, and repayment
- Regular updates to members on the fund, grants given, and repayments received
- Fair decisions based on purpose and readiness - not personal favour
- Careful oversight under Gotabgaa's constitution and Australian law

10. Who Can Take Part?

E-Fare welcomes Gotabgaa Australia members in good standing across NSW, SA, VIC, QLD, NT, TAS, ACT, and WA - whether you are new to the country, growing a trade, or investing in learning.

Examples of welcome purposes

- Starting or growing a small business (stock, equipment, licensing)
- Training and professional development
- Tools, transport, or assets that help you earn
- Community-minded enterprise
- Other purposes the committee agrees support self-reliance and growth

11. Our Non-Profit Promise

Gotabgaa Australia will remain a non-profit. E-Fare is not a money-making scheme for anyone. Fees, repaid funds, and any small late fees return only to the empowerment fund and careful running of the programme.

Success is not measured in profit. It is measured in businesses started, families strengthened, and a community that chose to stand together.

12. Your Review and Vote

Dear colleagues: please read this with an open heart, share your thoughts freely, and help us decide together.

We kindly ask each interim leader to

- Read the full proposal (including the 2-3 member circle, the three-guarantor rule, business evidence, repayment, and recovery)
- Discuss any questions or improvements in an Interim Leadership meeting
- Vote to: (a) Approve as presented; (b) Approve with amendments; or (c) Defer for more discussion
- Record the outcome clearly so next steps are transparent

SUGGESTED WORDING FOR THE VOTE

That the Interim Leadership Team of Gotabgaa Australia adopts the Empowerment Fare (E-Fare) proposal - including six-month modules limited to 2-3 members at a time, with the next group supported only after repayments return; a mandatory Statement of Investment; the rule that any member who intends to borrow must provide three guarantors and evidence of the business the money will be injected into (including business registration or equivalent); interest-free support; a 1%-2% late admin fee if overdue; recovery action where repayment is delayed too long or avoided; and the power to suspend or end E-Fare membership in such cases - with detailed operating rules to be finalised by the E-Fare committee.

Thank you for walking this path with us. May our decision serve our people - in peace, love, and unity.

Presented for Interim Leadership review and vote

Gotabgaa Australia - Interim Leadership Team